

ONE OF INDIA'S largest hospitals, the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in New Delhi, was hit by a ransomware attack in November 2022. The attack cut off access to approximately 1.3 terabytes of data and impacted the hospital's elec-

tronic medical records system. Its patient scheduling and billing systems were also affected, forcing the hospital to curtail its outpatient services for several days. Not only did it inconvenience patients, it also resulted in substantial financial losses for the hospital. After this incident, AIIMS strengthened its network by switching to a dedicated and secure local area network, among other security measures. Six months later, when another malware attack was mounted, it was thwarted.

This isn't an isolated incident. Such instances are rising across both government and private enterprises. Data from Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) reveals that India Inc. encountered nearly 1.4 million cyberattacks in 2022, and among these, attacks on cloud systems were the highest. "With the adoption of digital technologies, critical infrastructure systems are no longer air-gapped, exposing them to significant cyber vulnerabilities. This shift has become particularly evident due to the increased reliance on digital solutions, virtualisation of government and citizen services, and the rise of remote workforces," says Samir Kumar Mishra, Director of Security Business at Cisco India & SAARC.

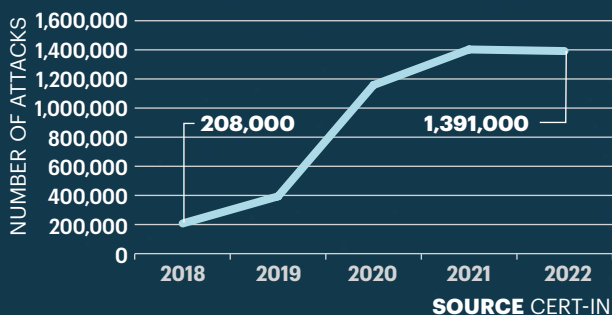
Incidentally, attacks on cloud-based networks per organisation has increased by 48 per cent between 2021 and 2022, per data from cybersecurity solutions provider Check Point Software Technologies. As organisations grapple with the rising complexity of managing security across multiple environments, and struggle to detect and respond to emerging threats that span on-premise and other cloud set-ups, security is emerging as a top priority. Consequently, the global cloud security software market—that was worth \$29.3 billion in 2022—is expected to reach \$39.3 billion by 2028, per market research firm IMARC Group. Revenues of India's cloud market are also expected to clock \$25.39 million in 2023, and reach \$136.20 million by 2028.

BUT WHY THE CLOUD?

As businesses increasingly adopt cloud-based solutions, cyber criminals—who are constantly looking for new vulnerabilities to exploit—are finding it easier to engineer data breaches, explains Rajesh Garg, EVP,

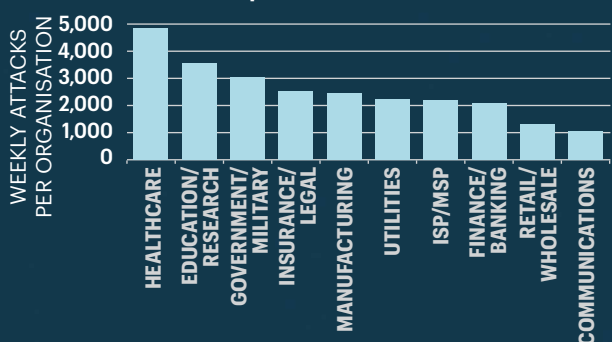
UNDER ATTACK

Instances of cyberattacks in India have gone up in the past few years



A BARRAGE OF BREACHES

Some of the most impacted industries



ISP INTERNET SERVICE PROVIDER;
MSP MANAGED SERVICE PROVIDER

SOURCE THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT INDIA-CHECK POINT

5.1
PER CENT

ESTIMATED CAGR OF THE
GLOBAL CLOUD SECURITY
SOFTWARE MARKET
BETWEEN 2022 AND 2028

SOURCE IMARC GROUP

39.93
PER CENT

ESTIMATED CAGR OF CLOUD
SECURITY SOFTWARE
MARKET IN INDIA BETWEEN
2023 AND 2028

Chief Digital Officer & Head of Applications & Cybersecurity at data centre service provider Yotta Data Services. Around 98 per cent of organisations globally now utilise some form of cloud-based tech, while many have adopted multi-cloud deployments from multiple cloud service providers. The massive adoption of the cloud environment has also given rise to Shadow IT, where employees or departments use hardware or software from external sources without the knowledge of the IT or security group of the organisation. This creates a vacuum, where the responsibility of managing security within organisations is not clearly defined.

"Cloud infrastructure is inherently complex; that